

DESCRIPTION

This ceramics course covers both technical skills for throwing and aesthetic analysis in the area of pottery. We will cover a set of fundamental throwing skills for weights up to 5 lbs (and more) with a focus on efficiency and ergonomics. We will also cover analytical skills that will help you identify areas for improvement in your own throwing as well as increase your ability to plan your work in advance. Lastly, we set aside time for special techniques that students in the class wish to pursue. Optionally, we can schedule outside class sessions for practical critique if the students wish to do that.

CALENDAR

Session 1

Fundamentals: Water & Centering 6/29 7:30-9:30pm

- **Techniques:** Reducing water usage. Centering short and tall. Ergonomics. Opening tall.
- **Analysis:** Critique: When to do it? Not while making. Observation: When to do it? Always.
- **Exercises:** Center and recenter without adding water. Opening tall.

Session 2

Fundamentals: Opening & Pulling 7/13 7:30-9:30pm

- **Techniques:** Basic knuckle pull (using larger tools than fingertips). Collaring pull. Compression Pull. Shaping out and in.
- **Analysis:** Observing shape: defining curves, sections, and finding ratios.
- **Exercises:** Compress base with fist to create walls; Compress small plates off the hump.

Session 3

Fundamentals: Adding Weight 6/20 7:30-9:30pm

- **Techniques:** Centering more weight tall. Opening more weight. Pulling more weight.
- **Analysis:** Refining shape: how to iterate quickly with drawings.
- **Exercises:** Weight progression to failure. Adding time pressure. Throw 3x 3lb giving yourself 30 minutes total. If you can throw the pot do the same but add 1lb. Find the weight where you cannot finish all three in 30 minutes.

Session 4

Review: Throwing 6/27 7:30-9:30pm

- **Techniques:** Work out the kinks on an individual level.
- **Analysis:** Unjudging aesthetics: Good and bad (quality of result) vs rough and precise (character of the work).
- **Exercises:** (Maybe) Wiring off the hump. Compression cups off the hump.

Session 5

Fundamentals: Chucks & Attachments 7/3 7:30-9:30pm

- **Techniques:** Throwing and altering a wet chuck. Handles, Lugs, and Buttons.
- **Analysis:** Observing surface: defining color, texture, and gloss.
- **Exercises:** Make a cup chuck (11cm base, 7cm top, 12cm tall).

Session 6

Fundamentals: Glazing 7/10 7:30-9:30pm

- **Techniques:** Dipping glaze. Pouring glaze. Painting with slip. Waxing.
- **Analysis:** Putting it all together with composition.
- **Exercises:** Make a cup chuck (11cm base, 7cm top, 12cm tall).

Session 7

Special Topics: Q&A 7/17 7:30-9:30pm

At this point we have covered all of the fundamental topics. Students are encouraged to come with questions on additional forms or technique that either weren't covered or they wish to delve into deeper. If there are no such questions or we end up with a lull then we will all make teapots.